

Who picks up

Read this once before you dial. The whole script is built around this person.

Their day

Up a tree or in the truck since 6. The phone is how jobs come in, so they answer unknown numbers. Hoping it's a customer. Hands full. Maybe English is their second language.

What they want

Steady, good jobs: removals, not \$150 trims. Customers who call them directly. To stop paying Angi for leads other crews get too. Nothing that eats their evenings.

What they fear

Another marketer who promised "page one of Google," took the money and vanished. Contracts. Looking dumb about tech. Wasting ten minutes they don't have.

So every line does one of three things: proves you actually looked at their business, takes risk off them, or hands them control. If English is hard for them: slow down, use short words, and offer to email a screenshot.

HI Be honest in the first ten seconds

They're thinking: "Unknown number. Customer? ... No. Sales call. How do I get off?"

"Hey, is this [name]? Hey [name], it's Miles with Built for Main Street. I'll be straight with you, this is a cold call. Got 30 seconds, or did I catch you in the middle of something?"

Saying "cold call" first means they don't feel tricked. The question gives them the exit, and people who are handed the exit usually stay. Busy? "No problem. Morning or after 4 better?" Write it down and call then.

SAW Make it about their customers, not you

They're thinking: "What are you selling? Is this a robot reading a script?"

No website: "I was looking up tree guys in [town] this morning, like a homeowner would. Asked ChatGPT who to call. It named [name] and [name]. Not you. And there's no website for Google to send people to. Did you know that?"

Site with a problem: "Quick heads-up, not sure anyone's told you. I was on your website this morning and [the one thing you saw]. Did you know that?"

Competitors' names by name sting a little and prove you really looked. A problem on their site framed as a heads-up feels like a favor, like telling someone their tail light is out. Then stop talking and count to three. Their answer tells you everything.

ASK Let them talk about their business

They're thinking: "I do fine. Where's this going?"

"Where's most of your work coming from right now? Word of mouth? Angi?"

"What kind of jobs do you want more of?"

Owners like talking about their work, and nobody asks them. Their answers are your pitch: if they pay Angi, being found directly saves them money. If they want removals, that's the page you build first. Write it down.

BOOK Take all the risk off them

They're thinking: "What's the catch? How much? Am I signing something?"

"I'm not an agency. It's just me, I'm local, and I do this one business at a time. Free check, ten minutes. I show you what a customer sees when they look you up, and you decide if it matters. Tomorrow morning or after 4?"

"Cool. Best email to send it to?"

Free, short, and "you decide" answers the catch. Two times to pick from is easier than "when works?" If they ask the price: "Honestly, it depends on how many services and towns you cover. After the check I give you one number, and it doesn't change." That tells them you won't make a price up on the spot.

When they push back: what they mean

Pushback is rarely a no. It's a worry. Answer the worry, not the words.

THEY SAY	WHAT THEY MEAN	YOU SAY
"How much?"	"Are you going to rip me off?"	"Depends on services and towns, so I won't guess. After the check, one number, and it doesn't move. No contract either."
"Another marketing company?"	"I've been burned before."	"No. No ads, no social media, no contract, no 'page one' promises. It's me. I get you found and easy to call, and you see the numbers every month."
"Word of mouth keeps me busy."	"I'm doing fine. Don't tell me I'm failing."	"Love that, that's the best customer there is. Those people still look you up before they call. Right now they find [what you saw]."
"I use Angi."	"I already pay for leads and it sort of works."	"Keep it if it's working. Those leads usually go to several crews at once. This is for people searching for you directly, so you're not paying per lead for them."
"Just send me something."	"Get off my phone politely."	"Sure. What's your email? I'll send a screenshot today and call you Thursday for two minutes." Now you have an email and a date.
"My nephew does it."	"I'm loyal to family."	"Good, keep him on it. The part that slips is the Google listing and what ChatGPT says, checked every month. Happy to show him what I found."
"I'm up a tree."	Literally.	"Go. When are you on the ground, 4:30?" Write it down. Call at 4:30.
"Is this a scam?"	"Prove you're real."	"Fair question. builtformainstreet.com. The check is free, you pay nothing unless you go ahead, and the domain stays in your name."
"Not interested."	Maybe timing. Maybe no.	"All good. Is it timing, or you just don't want more of this kind of work?" One try. Then: "Appreciate you. Have a good one."
"Don't call again."	It's a no.	"Understood, you're off the list." Tap Dead. Never call again.

VOICEMAIL 20 seconds

They're thinking (listening later in the truck): "Customer? Or junk?"

"Hey [name], Miles with Built for Main Street. I looked you up this morning like a customer would, and found something you'll want to see. It's free, takes ten minutes. [number]. Again, [number]. Talk soon."

"Like a customer would" and "free" are the two things that make a busy owner call back. Same day: send the email if you have one.

Rules: Call from Voice, never your cell. No texts to businesses. Never a range. Never promise rankings, leads or revenue. Three tries, then Dead. If you record, say so first. Tap how it went after every call.

Call two: the check, then one price

They said yes to ten minutes. Now they're deciding if you're worth it.

SHOW Their business, through a stranger's eyes

They're thinking: "Is this actually a problem, or is he making it up?"

"Pulled it up. Here's what a homeowner sees when they look for you." Read them what ChatGPT said, word for word. Show the screenshot.

Their own name on the screen does the selling. You don't have to argue.

COUNT Let the numbers pick the price

They're thinking: "He's going to size me up and charge what he thinks I can pay."

"How many services do you do? Which towns do most of your customers come from?"

Counting out loud shows the price comes from their business, not from a guess about their wallet. That's why it never moves.

PRICE One number, then stop talking

They're thinking: "How much, and what am I stuck with?"

Up to 4 services, 3 towns, one location "\$600 to build it, then \$99 a month. That keeps it hosted, edited, and your Google listing right."

Up to 8 services, 6 towns (most) "\$800 to build it, then \$199 a month. That adds a monthly report on what Google and ChatGPT say about you, and review requests."

More, or two locations "\$1,000 to build it, then \$300 a month. That adds same-day follow-up on every new lead and a call with me every month."

Then silence. The first one to talk loses. If they want less, cut services from the site, never the price: "If we do four services, it's the \$600 plan."

TERMS Answer "what am I stuck with?"

"The domain's in your name. No long contract: cancel with 30 days' notice. After a year you can buy the site outright. Want me to send the agreement and payment link?"

Everything they fear about marketers (lock-in, disappearing, owning nothing) is answered in three sentences. Money and photos first, then the two-week clock starts.

Warm: people who already know you

Same prices, same rules. Money and photos first. Never Venmo.

CLIENT #1 The trainer: finish, then ask

He's thinking: "I paid, and it's not quite done."

"Hey [name], it's Miles. I want to finish your site properly: live, tap to call, your Google listing done. Can you send me 10 photos by Friday?"

When it's live, show him on his phone, then:

"Would you give me two sentences on what it was like working with me?"

"Who are two other trainers or studio owners you'd trust me with?"

"To keep it hosted, edited and your listing current, it's \$99 a month. Want me to set that up?"

FRIENDS People who know what you're doing

They're thinking: "I want to help. I just don't know how."

"Hey [name], quick favor. I'm building websites and fixing Google listings for local businesses now. Know anyone who owns a shop, a crew, a studio, anything local, whose site is bad or who's hard to find? Just a name is huge."

A specific ask ("a name") is easy to say yes to. Then: "Could you text them my number and say I'll call?"

FRIEND A friend who needs a site: no pressure

She's thinking: "I don't want this to get awkward."

"Hey [name]! I heard you might need a website for [business]. I build them for local businesses through my business, Built for Main Street. Happy to take a look if you want. No pressure either way."

Talk about the business, not your job. If she wants it: count, quote the plan she lands in, and make the thank-you a gift ("the first two months are on me"), never a discount.

Why warm matters: your only sale so far came through a friend. Every warm conversation ends with a testimonial or a name. They add to the cold calls. They never replace them.